

black hat hackers and grey hat hackers. Now let's understand them in some detail.

White hat hackers

These are the guys you'd want by your side. Also called ethical hackers, these individuals are cybersecurity experts who are hired and paid by companies and governments to perform penetration testing and discover flaws and gaps in the entity's organization-wide computer systems. With good intentions and necessary clearance, they hack into the system and find out vulnerabilities. All of this is done to ensure protection against black hat hackers and other malicious cybercrimes.

Black hat hackers

Taking credit for the negative persona around "hacking," these guys are your culprits. Heard a piece of news about a new cybercrime today, it's the black hat hackers who are behind all of them.

Monetary gains incentivise most black hat hackers, but it's not the only reason. Airport systems, banks, PCs, or any network-based software systems can become their potential target. They exploit vulnerabilities and gain unauthorized access to your personal, financial and technical data. Sometimes the goal is notoriety in their own circles, or even public fame, but usually it all boils down to desiring power and money.

Grey hat hackers

Grey hat hackers lie somewhere between white and black hats. They break into systems without consent, but if they find any loopholes or backdoors, they bring it to the attention of the authorities or propose to fix them in exchange for financial rewards. There have been numerous instances where the grey hat hackers, on denial of rewards, have leaked the vulnerability onto the internet for the whole world to see.

Since a grey hat hacker does not cross that line of using their expertise for personal profit, however blurry that line might be, they stay away from the black hat label. However, since they still use illegitimate means to break into a system, they can't be called a white hat hacker either and are therefore subject to judicial punishments.

Careers

The growth of data-centred marketing and economy has also led to